

Jothi Teaching Standards

DIGITAL BOARD TEACHING STANDARD

Operational standard for using the digital board to support clear explanation, diagnostic teaching, and visible reasoning

Author	Prakash Micheal — Johti Learning, United Kingdom
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Related Documents	JF03 v2.0, JTS01 v2.0, JTS05 v2.0, JTD01 v2.0, JTD04 v2.0

1. Purpose

The digital board is not optional in Johti teaching. It is the primary surface for making reasoning visible. This standard defines how tutors are expected to use it and what poor board use looks like.

In online tutoring, the board is often the student's main access point to the tutor's thinking. Poor board use weakens clarity even when the tutor understands the subject well. Strong board use slows teaching to a learnable pace and creates diagnostic opportunities that would otherwise not exist.

Linked competency: C1 (Explaining with Clarity and Structure). Board use is not assessed separately — it is part of how C1 is evidenced.

2. Core Board Principles

Principle	What It Requires	What It Prevents
Legibility	Writing large enough to read comfortably. Clear symbols and notation. Adequate spacing between steps.	Students spending cognitive effort decoding the board rather than understanding the content.
Step-by-step structure	Each step written in sequence. No unexplained jumps. Substitutions, transformations, and intermediate reasoning shown.	Students having to infer missing steps — which means they are filling gaps with guesswork, not understanding.
Appropriate pacing	Board writing paced for the student's processing speed — not the tutor's	Students still processing Step 2 while the board shows Step 5.

Principle	What It Requires	What It Prevents
Reasoning over decoration	comfort. Pause after key steps. Do not race ahead. Board content shows how an answer is built, not just where it ends. Layout conveys logical structure.	Boards that look neat but show only final answers, giving students no route into the thinking.
Uncluttered layout	Sufficient space between sections. Important steps stand out through position, not colour or excess notation.	A crowded board that is visually confusing even when the content is technically correct.

3. Board Use Across the 4T Cycle

Phase	How the Board Supports It	Practical Example
Teach	Show each reasoning step clearly and in sequence. The board makes the explanation trackable and re-readable.	When introducing simultaneous equations: write both equations, label the method chosen, show the elimination step by step — each line below the last.
Test	Point to a specific line and ask the student to explain it. Deliberately omit a step and ask the student to complete it. Present an incorrect method and ask the student to identify the flaw.	Cover the last two lines of a worked solution and ask: 'What would the next step be and why?'
Track	Use the student's written work on the board or Classkick to observe their reasoning — not just their final answer. Watch which step they hesitate before.	Ask the student to write the next step while you watch. Their hesitation point reveals exactly where understanding breaks down.
Transform	Isolate the exact point where reasoning went wrong. Rewrite the step clearly. Contrast the incorrect and correct methods side by side where helpful.	Leave the student's incorrect step visible. Write the correct version alongside it. Ask: 'What is different here and why does it matter?'

4. Subject-Specific Board Requirements

Subject	Board Requirements
Mathematics	Show algebraic steps without collapsing transformations the student still needs to see. Use layout to separate methods, cases, or stages of working. Make diagrams, graphs, and geometric constructions readable and accurately proportioned.
Physics	Show formulae clearly with units visible at every substitution. Model substitution step by step — values in, units tracked, answer extracted. Separate known values, formula, working, and result logically. Use diagrams where they genuinely clarify a physical concept.
Chemistry	Write chemical equations clearly and accurately — symbols, charges, and states where required. Model balancing step by step. Keep structural diagrams readable. Make the relationship between particle-level and equation-level representations explicit.

5. Student Participation Through the Board

The board should be a shared thinking space, not a one-way display. Tutors should regularly involve the student through the board.

- Ask the student to explain what a visible step means before moving to the next one.
- Ask the student to predict the next line and write it themselves where possible.
- Ask the student to identify where an error occurred in a worked example on the board.
- Ask the student to compare two written approaches and say which is correct and why.
- Ask the student to complete a partial solution from the point the tutor has stopped.

When students write on the board or into Classkick, their working becomes visible. That visibility is the Track phase in action.

6. Common Board Errors

Error	Instructional Impact
Writing too small to read comfortably	Creates unnecessary cognitive load. Students spend effort decoding the board rather than understanding the content.
Writing too quickly for the student to follow	The student's processing cannot keep up. They appear to follow because they are not interrupting — not because they understand.
Showing only final answers	The student sees where the explanation ended but not how it got there. Understanding cannot be built from results alone.
Overcrowding the board	Visual clutter makes it impossible to see the logical structure of the working, even when each individual step is correct.
Leaving incorrect working unaddressed	If incorrect working remains visible without correction, it competes with the correct version and embeds the wrong idea.
Prioritising neatness over instructional clarity	A beautiful board that takes three minutes to set up and shows no live reasoning is a presentation, not teaching.

7. What Mentors Observe

When reviewing board use, mentors observe whether:

- Writing is legible and well-paced — the student can follow in real time.
- Reasoning is shown step by step — no unexplained jumps.
- The board supports diagnostic questioning — specific steps can be questioned, hidden, or compared.
- Student thinking is made visible through the board — their working, hesitation, and corrections appear.

- Corrections are handled on the board — errors are isolated, contrasted, and rebuilt clearly.

Board use is assessed as part of C1 (Explaining with Clarity and Structure). It is not a separate competency but it is a primary evidence source for that competency.

8. Version Notes — Changes from v1.0

Change	Reason
Core board principles presented as a table with 'What It Prevents' column	v1.0 described principles in prose. The table format makes each principle and its consequence immediately usable during coaching.
4T cycle mapped to specific board use examples	v1.0 described board use by 4T phase in general terms. v2.0 adds a practical example for each phase to make the connection concrete.
Competency code explicitly linked (C1)	v1.0 did not connect board use to specific competency codes. v2.0 makes clear that board quality is evidence for C1.
'Rationale for live board writing' section removed	v1.0 included a full section on why live writing is preferable to slides. This belongs in the SKOOL course philosophy pages, not in an operational standard.
Common errors table restructured to show instructional impact	v1.0 listed errors as bullet points. v2.0 adds the consequence column so tutors understand why each error matters.

Jothi Learning — United Kingdom

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